- Assist the woman in the use of positioning cushions and pillows while sitting or lying.
- Administer pain medication as indicated.

Minor Ailments in Postnatal Period

- After pains
- Retention of urine
- Pain at site of perineum
- Engorgement of breast
- Treatment of Anaemia

Postnatal Exercise

- Pelvic floor exercise
- Abdominal tightening
- Pelvic tilting or rocking
- Hip hitching
- Foot and Leg Exercise

Immediate postpartum exercises can be performed in bed.

- Toe Stretch (tightens calf muscles)- While lying on your back, keep your legs straight and point your toes away from you, then pull your legs toward you and point your toes toward your chest. Repeat 10 times.
- Pelvic floor exercise (tightens perineal muscles)-Contract your buttocks for the count of 5 and relax. Contract your buttocks and press thighs together for the count of 7 and relax. Contract buttocks, press thighs together, and draw in anus for the count of 10 and relax.

Care of New Born

- Keeping baby warm
- Maintain Hygiene
- Cord care
- Breast feeding
- Immunization



- Average lifetime risk of maternal death for a woman in least developed country is >300 times than in industrialized country
- In developing world a woman has 1 in 76 lifetime risk of maternal death as compared to 1 in 8000 in industrialized countries
- Global MMR stood at 430/lakh live births in 1990, and at 400/lakh in 2005

Health Education

Postpartum Care and Hygiene

Advise the mother to wash perineum daily and after passing urine and stools. Change perineal pads every 4 - 6 hours. Wash hands frequently and take bath daily.

Nutritional Advice

Increase intake of fluid and food especially iron and protein rich foods like green leafy vegetables, jaggery, lentils, eggs and meat. Increase intake of milk and milk products like curd, cheese etc. Calorie need per day 2200+700 =2900 Kcal Advise adequate rest.

IFA Supplementation

Women with normal Hb are advised to take 1 IFA tablet daily for 3 months. If Hb below 11 gm/dl, advise her to take 2 IFA tabs daily and repeat Hb after 1 month.

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